cooperation."[33] He reached out to Donald Trump with his visit to the United States in June 2017 and declared that India "considers the US its primary partner for (its) social and economic transformation."[34] This is a remarkable statement for an Indian politician to make on American soil, but it underscores the distance India has travelled from its non-aligned days.

The regional balance of power in Asia was the big focus when Modi and Trump declared their two nations "as responsible stewards in the Indo-Pacific region," agreeing that a close partnership between the United States and India is central to peace and stability in the region. Without mentioning China, they reiterated "the importance of respecting freedom of navigation, overflight, and commerce throughout the region" and called "upon all nations to resolve territorial and maritime disputes peacefully and in accordance with international law." What was even more striking was the subtle reference to China's Belt and Road Initiative when the two leaders talked of

> bolstering regional economic connectivity through the transparent development of infrastructure and the use of responsible debt financing practices, while ensuring respect for sovereignty and territorial integrity, the rule of law, and the environment; and call on other nations in the region to adhere to these principles.[35]

Terrorism was another big win for India. On the one hand, the United States "welcomed further Indian contributions to promote Afghanistan's democracy, stability, prosperity, and security," while on the other, the two nations reiterated their commitment "to strengthen cooperation against terrorist threats from groups including Al-Qa'ida, ISIS, Jaish-e-Mohammad, Lashkar-e-Tayyiba, D-Company, and their affiliates." The designation of the Hizb-ul-Mujahideen leader